Cloud Cost Waste Checklist

10 checks that find money hiding in your cloud bill - Aravind Mutte

1 Unattached EBS volumes / disks

Detached storage keeps billing after the VM is gone. List volumes with no attachments monthly and snapshot-then-delete.

2 Idle load balancers

A load balancer with no healthy targets still bills hourly. Remove or consolidate ones serving no traffic.

3 Oversized instances (rightsizing)

If average CPU is under 20% for weeks, drop one instance size. Start with dev/staging fleets where it's risk-free.

4 Old snapshots piling up

Snapshots are cheap individually and expensive collectively. Keep a retention policy (e.g. 30 days) and automate pruning.

5 Forgotten dev / staging environments

Staging stacks left running 24/7 are the #1 silent waster. Auto-shutdown schedules save 60%+ on non-prod.

6 Data transfer between zones/regions

Cross-AZ traffic is billed. Co-locate chatty services in the same zone where architecture allows.

7 Unassociated Elastic IPs

Allocated but unattached public IPs bill hourly on AWS. Release anything not attached to a running resource.

8 CloudWatch / logging without retention

Logs with 'never expire' grow forever. Set lifecycle retention (30-90 days) on log groups and buckets.

9 Over-provisioned databases

RDS/Cloud SQL running at 10% CPU can usually drop a tier. Use Performance Insights before deciding.

10 No budgets or billing alerts

The cheapest check of all: set a monthly budget alert at 50%, 80%, 100% so surprises never happen again.

Want these fixed for you?

I do fixed-scope cloud cost audits and DevOps engagements. Reach me at mutthe.aravind@gmail.com or book a free 30-min intro call from the contact page.